

“LoRaWAN is an open system and is a global standard”

Donna Moore

chief executive officer and chairwoman, LoRa Alliance



What is LoRa Alliance all about? How can it benefit creators of the Internet of Things (IoT) solutions in India and across the globe? When **Rahul Chopra** got a chance to meet the **Alliance's chief executive officer and chairwoman, Donna Moore**, she not only explained membership benefits for device-makers but also for system integrators, enterprise customers and even network operators

Q. What is the goal of LoRa Alliance? What value does it bring to members?

A. The goal of the Alliance is to promote the LoRaWAN standard. It is an open alliance and accepts all members. The goal is really three-fold. First, it is to (continuously) develop specifications as the market changes and needs evolve.

Second is marketing. We promote LoRaWAN specifications and its members through social media, events and whitepapers. So, for companies that do not have the funds to market, we use our voice to raise them in terms of LoRaWAN specifications.

Third is certification. With billions of devices in the marketplace, it is important to know which ones will not operate as anticipated. For this, we have a robust certification programme. Devices that get implemented must be LoRaWAN-certified. This encourages government agencies to include bids for LoRaWAN-certified devices.

Q. Why should device-makers become a member of LoRa Alliance?

A. Developers are always looking at new, unlimited use-cases. Anything can be connected. If device-makers want you to have an anchor use-case, or application such as metering, then once networks engage, you can add more use-cases. So, they have unlimited potential in the market. By being members of LoRa Alliance, they get the test tool for pre-certification.

We have local test houses for certification, beneficial especially for smaller companies. We market actual use-cases of developer companies and how these can be implemented and promoted.

Q. What is in it for telecom operators?

A. We have mobile network operators, multi-user service operators and private operators. The split between public and private operators is about fifty per cent. We have seen

big growth in private implementations over the last few years. For operators, it is another opportunity to capture the market. Because of the flexibility of LoRaWAN and the ability to add gateways to their towers, it is an opportunity to have both cellular and non-licensed opportunities for their networks.

Through membership, they get the opportunity to meet and collaborate with the entire ecosystem. For example, many of our network operators in Europe used to do their own testing for each device taken on to their network. This costed them a lot of money and time. Now, the Alliance is in the process of working with all network operators in Europe and is bringing testing over to the Alliance.

Q. Does deployment of complete solutions have any value for system integrators who are neither device-makers nor network operators, but are implementing it?

